Pembrolizumab 400 mg · colorectal

To help control metastatic bowel cancer confirmed MSI-H/dMMR, as first-line treatment.

First-line metastatic MSI-H / dMMR colorectal cancer · NCCP 00558 v13 · Document revised 5 November 2026

Your personal plan: this is the standard regimen schedule. Your team confirms your prescribed doses, cycles, treatment changes and appointments in your written plan.

First-line metastatic MSI-H/dMMR colorectal cancer only. Other cancer types and treatment settings require their own plan.

My overall treatment

Day 1: pembrolizumab 400 mg over about 30 minutes. Repeat every 6 weeks; allow extra time for checks.

42 day view

Treatment timing in this window

Infusion — Day 1

One immunotherapy medicine

Continue while helpful and tolerable. Sustained response at 24 months prompts an individual review, not an automatic stop.

A typical 42-day cycle

Day 1	Day 2–42
Infusion and assessment	Between infusions

Timing may change after review. Side effects can occur on any day; there are no guaranteed safe days.

My tests and checks

When	What is checked	Timing / reason
Before	**Baseline tests** Required	Blood count, kidneys, liver, glucose, thyroid and validated tumour MSI/MMR result.
Each cycle	**Bloods and symptoms** Required	Blood count, kidneys, liver and glucose before every infusion.
Between / after	**Thyroid / hormones** Required / conditional	During: thyroid every 3–6 weeks; cortisol if indicated. After: follow persistent effects as agreed.
Review	**Scans and markers** Individual plan	Consultant-agreed timing; no fixed interval in this regimen.

Between treatments

- Immune effects can start on any day or after treatment ends. Report new symptoms promptly.
- Keep separate thyroid appointments when needed. Do not wait until your next infusion to seek help.

Bring your medicine list, alert card and questions; confirm test dates and urgent contact numbers.

When to get help

Call 112 / 999 for severe breathing difficulty, severe chest pain, collapse or a seizure.

Call oncology immediately: temperature 37.5°C or above, 36°C or below, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your hospital's temperature instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment. Do not wait for the next appointment.

Oncology daytime: 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

EXAMPLE ONLY — team must replace both numbers before patient use.

Feasibility build. Clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Your team confirms your personal plan.

What to watch for

You do not need to know which medicine caused a symptom before calling.

1 Hormones / nervous system

Pembrolizumab

Severe headache, confusion, weakness, dizziness or marked thirst need prompt advice.

3 Heart

Pembrolizumab

Chest pain, racing heartbeat or fainting needs urgent assessment.

5 Kidneys

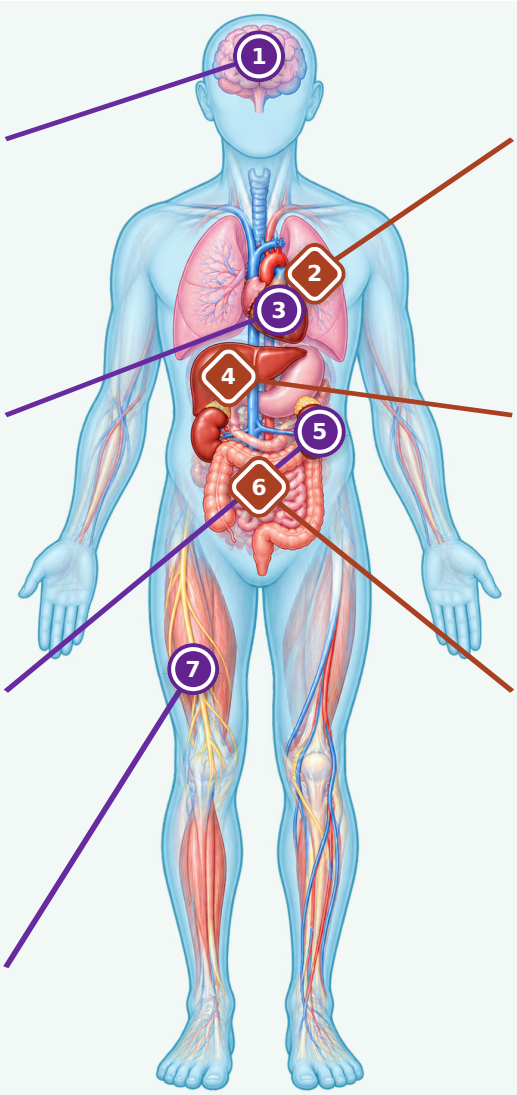
Pembrolizumab

Report much less urine, new swelling or a change in kidney tests.

7 Skin / muscles

Pembrolizumab

Spreading rash, blisters, severe weakness or muscle pain needs prompt review.



2 Lungs

Pembrolizumab

New cough or breathlessness can signal inflammation or another urgent cause.

4 Liver

Pembrolizumab

Yellow eyes/skin or dark urine may signal inflammation; tests also check the liver.

6 Bowel

Pembrolizumab

New or persistent diarrhoea, blood in stools or severe tummy pain needs urgent advice.

Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Contact oncology immediately for new breathlessness, persistent diarrhoea, severe tummy pain, yellow skin or eyes, much less urine, spreading or blistering rash, severe headache, marked weakness, confusion, unusual thirst or passing much more urine. Severe breathing difficulty, chest pain, collapse or seizure needs emergency care. Effects can begin after treatment ends.

When to get help

Call 112 / 999 for severe breathing difficulty, severe chest pain, collapse or a seizure.

Call oncology immediately: temperature 37.5°C or above, 36°C or below, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your hospital's temperature instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment. Do not wait for the next appointment.

Oncology daytime: 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

EXAMPLE ONLY — team must replace both numbers before patient use.

Feasibility build. Clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Your team confirms your personal plan.

Keep your treatment details to hand

First-line metastatic MSI-H / dMMR colorectal cancer · NCCP 00558 v13 · Document revised 5 November 2026

Print this page **one-sided on A4 at Actual size / 100%**. Cut only the dashed outer border around both panels. **Do not cut the centre line.** Fold with FRONT and BACK facing out, then glue or tape the blank backs together. Finished size: **85.6 × 54 mm**. Keep the stamp side writable.

FRONT / CONTACTS

My Treatment Card

SACTCheck

Name: _____

Pembrolizumab 400 · colorectal

400 mg IV Day 1 every 6 weeks · team confirms each cycle.

Phase: _____ Cycle plan: team to confirm

Daytime (EXAMPLE) 087 12345678

Out of hours (EXAMPLE) 087 87654321

Unwell or fever? Call oncology now.
Severe breathing difficulty, chest pain or collapse: **112 / 999.**

EXAMPLE NUMBERS — replace before patient use.

BACK / TREATMENT RECORD

My cycle record

Rolling treatment record; no fixed final cycle.

Cycle	Date / initials

My treatment information

Latest treatment date: _____

Plan changed? Ask the team to update this card.

CUT outer border

FOLD centre — do not cut

Keep the record accurate

The team dates and initials each recorded treatment unit when complete. A cycle is complete after its final planned dose; a weekly-treatment stamp records that weekly dose. Delays, omitted doses or a changed plan need a note or a replacement card. A stamp does not approve the next treatment. Keep any medicine-specific alert card too.

Put your treatment page on your phone

Scan your QR and check the treatment name. Save that page to your home screen.

iPhone / Safari

Tap Share → Add to Home Screen. Select Open as Web App if offered, then Add.

Android / Chrome

Tap the three-dot menu → Add to Home screen or Install and create shortcut. Choose the shortcut option and confirm.

Menu wording varies. The QR opens information, not a personal record. Paper stamps do not update the website. Check that the saved icon opens the correct treatment.

Your local contacts and resources

Oncology daytime: 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

EXAMPLE ONLY — team must replace both numbers before patient use.

Hospital / team: _____

Backup if the team cannot be reached: _____

Additional local services and resources will be added when confirmed. Your team must check and complete this page before patient use.

Feasibility build. Clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Your team confirms your personal plan.